

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

To determine the most likely diagnosis , let's consider the symptoms and clinical findings presented :

- 1 . The baby is born at 32 weeks gestation , which is considered premature . Premature babies are at higher risk for respiratory complications .
- 2 . The baby has tachypnea , subcostal and intercostal retractions , and nasal flaring , which indicate respiratory distress .
- 3 . The baby has cyanosis , which suggests a lack of oxygen in the body , potentially due to a respiratory or cardiac issue .
- 4 . The cyanosis is responding well to oxygen administration , indicating that the primary issue may be related to inadequate oxygenation due to respiratory factors rather than a cardiac issue .
- 5 . The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems , which suggests that the gastrointestinal tract is likely functioning normally .

Considering these points , the most likely diagnosis is related to a common respiratory condition in premature babies , which is related to the deficiency of surfactant in the lungs .

</think><answer> A . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)

